

DOOMED TO LIVE

HOVERCRAFT

ADVANCE PROMOTIONAL COPY · 05.12.26

NOT FOR RESALE

THROW ME A SEVEN.

In 2025 Gol and Ron revived Hovercraft's songs on three albums: Shaken Not Stirred, On The Rocks and Blown Away.

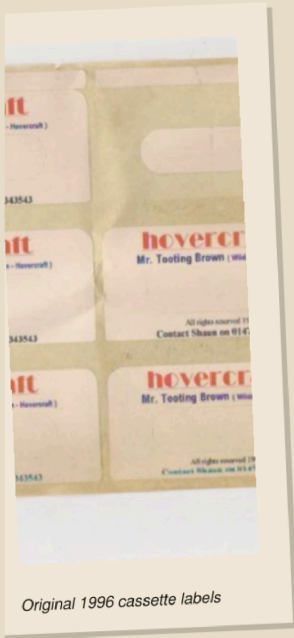
But we didn't want to release new recordings using Charlie's voice without his blessing, so we used a Suno-generated female voice instead. And we weren't sure anyone was ready to hear the real thing just yet.

And so we started the search for Pepper.

Ron contacted Pepper's old Facebook friends. A couple replied, but the last time they'd seen him, they said – years ago – he'd been in bad shape.

As a final throw of the dice, Gol sent another chat message. This time Charlie replied. He hadn't checked his old Gmail for months. Quite by chance, the message had triggered a phone notification.

Thirty years on, Hovercraft were finally ready for lift-off.



Original 1996 cassette labels

ARCHIVE EVIDENCE

28 MAY 1996

“FIFTY COPIES OF ABOVE.”

FAIRVIEW MUSIC
Great Gunter Lane West
Widley
Hull
HU10 6DP

Wednesday 28th May, 1996

~~For Mr. [unclear]~~
Master tape, enclosed. 6 songs, approx. 31 min. total playing time (30.40)

Quantity: ~~Twenty~~ Fifty copies of above.
Format: Ferric, White Shells, with Cases
Song order: As Master, ~~but not~~ single sided

Also: 18 sheets of Plain Self Adhesive Cassette Labels (white)
Twenty C90 Ferrics, ~~with~~ Clear Shells, with Cases
Twenty C60 Chromes, Black Shells, with Cases.

The surviving production note records the six-song master, 30:40 running time, ferric white shells, single-sided duplication - and an order for fifty copies. The order was completed in 1996; some of the finished tapes still survive.

THE TAPES DIDN'T DISAPPEAR.



Original demo cassettes, labels and surviving recordings sit beside the 2026 reconstructions. The archive is not decoration. It is the evidence the new record was built around.

HOW THE RECORD WAS MADE

A SMACK AND A POKE. REVIVING A DEAD BAND.

There was never a lost Hovercraft album sitting intact in a cupboard waiting for somebody to clean the hiss off it. What survived was messier: cassette recordings, damaged sources, lyric sheets, remembered chords, later performances, fragments and memory.

The 2026 recordings use Hovercraft's own songs, lyrics, performances and surviving recordings as source material. Generative audio tools, including Suno, were part of the reconstruction process; BandLab and Audacity were used in production and mastering. The songs were not invented from text prompts.

THE SCARS REMAIN. THE ARCHIVE REMAINS BESIDE THE REBUILD.

Full track-by-track provenance: hovercraft.band/songbook

KICK THE DOOR IN AND MAKE YOURSELF COMFORTABLE.

01 TO THE GRAVE

Get yourself free.

05 CONCRETE HILL

Trippy sunshine Saturday.

10 NEW PINE OVERCOAT

The promised land.

15 I LOVE YOU AND I DON'T WANT YOU TO DIE

When you're lonely.

17 NOW YOU'RE GOD / DYING COMES SO EASY

Pray for your son mama.

19 HERE NOW

The one thing that matters.

PRESS COPY / THE RECORD

THIRTY YEARS IN THE MAKING.

Nineteen songs, rebuilt from Hovercraft's own recordings, performances, lyrics and surviving tapes.

The original 1996 recordings remain available alongside the reconstructions on the companion release, Oh Yeah.



HOVERCRAFT / DOOMED TO LIVE

CREDITS

HOVERCRAFT

Charlie Pepper · Golly God · Ron Nasty · Mr Shimble

ORIGINAL LYRICS

Piers Wildman

ORIGINAL COMPOSITIONS

Wildman / Marsden / Downing / Downing

EXCEPTION

Here Now — Piers Wildman

COVER COMPOSITIONS

I'll Make Love To You Anytime — J. J. Cale; Cool Jerk — Donald Storboll

MANAGER

Sean Belvoir-Hunter

PRODUCTION

Golly God

PHOTOGRAPHY

Abby Rushton (The County, Grimsby); Kev Kenning (Goole)

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